

Engineering Handbook

How we build and ship software

Platform Team — 2026

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Welcome

This handbook describes how we work. It is the single source of truth for our engineering practices and is published as a PDF on every change.

Principles

1. **Reproducibility first.** If a build isn't deterministic, it isn't done.
2. **Secure by default.** The safe path is the easy path.
3. **Write it down.** Decisions live in version control, not in chat.

Development workflow

Branching

We use short-lived feature branches off `main` and squash-merge via pull request.

Code review

Check	Owner	Blocking
Tests pass	CI	yes
Lint clean	CI	yes
Design sound	Reviewer	yes

Check	Owner	Blocking
Docs updated	Author	no

Definition of done

- ☒ Tests added and passing
- ☒ Lint and format clean
- ☒ Documentation updated
- ☐ Changelog entry added
- ☐ Reviewed and approved

On-call

| | Page early, page often. It is always acceptable to escalate.

The primary on-call owns triage; the secondary owns communication. Runbooks live in **docs/runbooks/** and are kept current as part of the definition of done.

Tooling

```
# bootstrap a new service
platform init service --name billing
# run the full local check suite
platform check
```

Further reading

See the architecture decision records (ADRs) for the reasoning behind our infrastructure choices.